valley of Kashmir to seek his fortunes elsewhere in India. One can therefore presume that Mr Makandey Katju speaks with some authority when he states,

> When the British sentenced Bhagat Singh to death, Gandhi made no effort to save his life. He never wrote any letter to the British Viceroy to commute his sentence, nor did he issue any public appeal for this purpose, and he never went to meet Bhagat Singh in jail when the latter was on hunger strike.[17]

The same criticism cannot be made of India's first prime minister, Jawarharlal Nehru. As Irfan Habib notes, many in Congress privately approved of the assembly bomb explosion in April 1929, and Gandhi was all too aware of this, as is clear from the actions of none other than Nehru. As Habib states, 'Jawaharlal informed the Viceroy that "it is absurd to talk of unqualified condemnation of the young men who did it".' In fact, Nehru 'ridiculed the rulers' attempt to connect the bombs with Moscow, saying that "for them everything they (rulers) do not like comes from Moscow"'.[18] Nehru had gone so far as to 'publish the statements of Bhagat Singh and Dutt in the Congress Bulletin for which he was duly reprimanded by the Mahatma' after which '[a]pologising, Nehru wrote to Gandhi, "I am sorry you disapproved my giving Bhagat Singh and Dutt's statement in the Congress Bulletin"', but the fact was, as is clear from the *Selected Works of Jawaharlal Nehru*, he felt that he was 'compelled to publish the statement because there was very general appreciation of it among Congress circles'.[19]

Others such as Subhas Chandra Bose also saw the Lahore assembly bomb explosion as 'a visible expression of the revolutionary movement', such that it 'excited not only the public interest but public sympathy well'.[20] The inescapable fact, therefore is that given its lofty embrace of martyrdom, '[t]he second Lahore Conspiracy Case of 1929-30 occupied a place of pride in the liberation movement', in the words of S. Irfan Habib, because 'the principal accused' were revolutionaries who 'chose death in order to propagate their ideology and programme'.[21] Even though no one was killed and, indeed, there was no intention to kill, the impact of the Assembly bomb blast of April 1929 was, as Habib has put it, such that it 'rocked the